



TAKING REGULAR EXERCISE | EXERCISE 1

Keep an Exercise Log

1

Keep a record of your current weekly exercise level for a few weeks.

- Record duration, intensity and location.
- Note factors that prevented or enabled being able to exercise.

2

See where you can make small changes to reach the weekly exercise recommendations.

Example Weekly Exercise Log:

Day	Exercise & Duration Planned	Completed?	Factors which prevented or enabled being able to the exercise
Monday	Swimming 30 minutes	Yes	Arranged with a friend to meet up at the pool
Tuesday	Evening walk	No	Working in the office all day, followed by socialising
Wednesday	30 minutes moderate jog	No	Something urgent came up at work
Thursday	1 hour vigorous gym session	Yes	Trial Session with Personal Trainer
Friday	1 hour gym session	No	Too tired after previous session
Saturday	1 hour brisk walk	Yes	Planned the walk the night before with partner
Sunday	30 minute early morning walk	No	Had family over for the day



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Weekly Exercise Log

Day	Exercise & Duration Planned	Completed?	Factors which prevented or enabled being able to the exercise
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			



TAKING REGULAR EXERCISE | EXERCISE 2

Create Your New Exercise Plan

Using your findings from Exercise 1, create an exercise plan with a target of doing an average of 30 minutes moderate exercise 5-7 days per week. This aligns with the upper end of the Weekly Exercise Guidelines.



SET YOURSELF A GOAL

This needs to be specific, achievable and something YOU want to do. For example, having a brisk 30-minute walk every evening after dinner or swimming for one hour every other day before work.



PLAN AHEAD

On a weekly basis decide WHEN, WHERE and with WHOM you will be doing this exercise. Pack any exercise gear you need the night before. Possible examples include: a brisk 30-minute walk with your partner every evening, persuading a friend to join a team sport with you or taking on a challenge such as 'couch to 5k in 9 weeks'.



ANTICIPATE OBSTACLES

Invariably something may crop up to potentially disrupt your plans – a phone call, your partner is ill, rain, working away from home. Unless its urgent, you need to prioritise your health- say you will ring them back, put on a waterproof, go on your own, use the hotel gym. The more you push back on the demands of other people, the more they will respect that this is your time.



HAVE A ROUTINE

When you establish an exercise routine it becomes a habit, particularly if it includes daily exercise.



WEEKLY REVIEW

Keep a record of your exercise using the exercise plan. Even if you didn't manage to walk every day/swim every other day, it's better than no exercise, and you will be able to chart your progress.



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Create Your New Exercise Plan

Weekly Exercise Plan

Day	Exercise & Duration Planned	When	Where	With Whom	Completed?
Monday					
Tuesday					
Wednesday					
Thursday					
Friday					
Saturday					
Sunday					